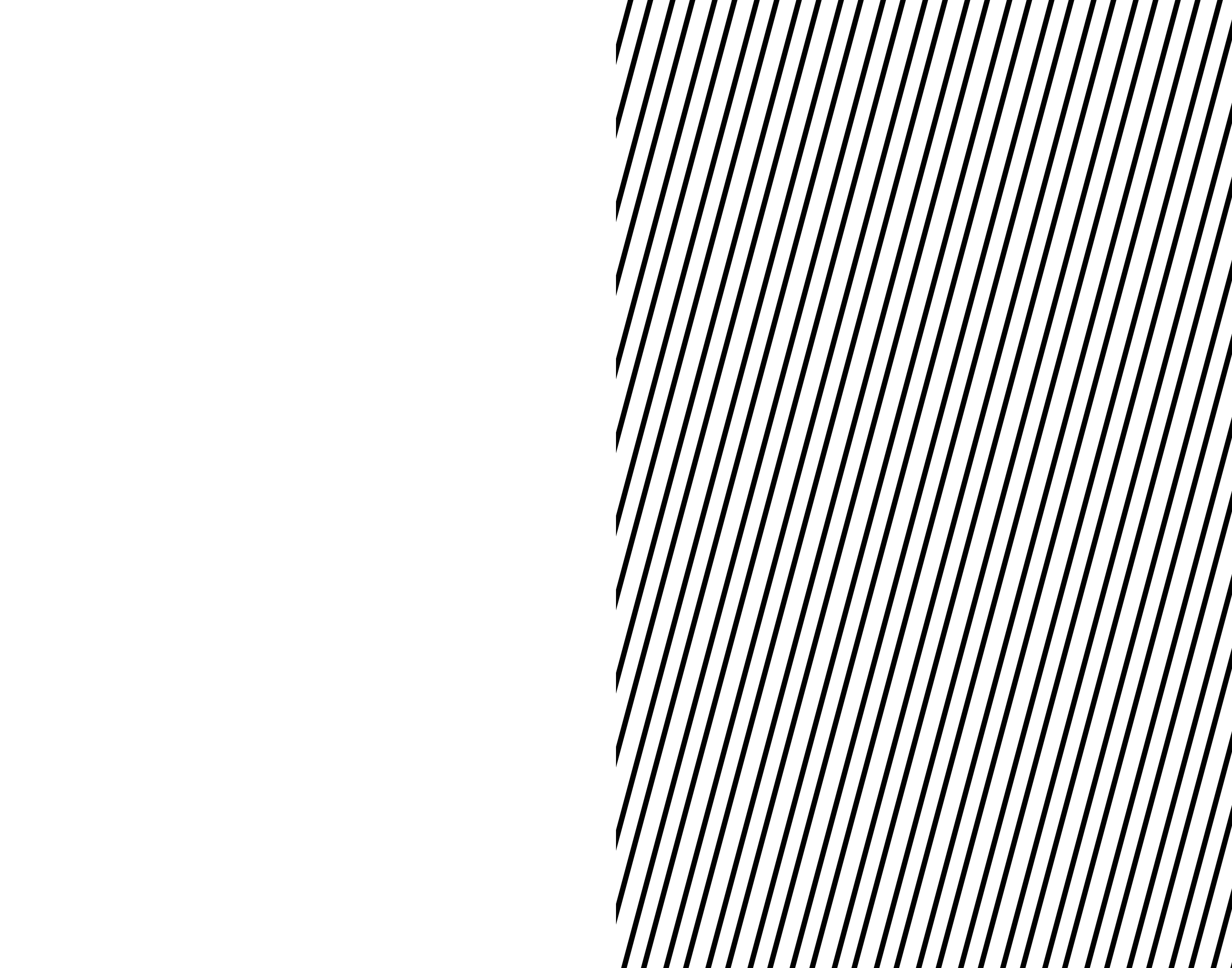


A circular arrangement of the phrase "Dong's Den Inside" in English and Chinese characters. The text is repeated multiple times around the circle, with the English words "Dong's", "Den", and "Inside" alternating with the Chinese characters "东", "的", and "窝".





圣诞树小记

读书小记?

毕业小记

二零二五年冬, 布鲁克林河边和Elena

二零二五年七月, 我在法国尼斯接到妈妈的电话说我的鼠死了, 我哭了一路哭到了瑞士

二零二五年在胡同里看到贴着“明天戈多准来”的破椅子

二零二四年夏, 哥大, 巴勒斯坦游行最严重的时候, TC没停课

二零二四年冬, 纽约, 片子剪到第五遍

二零二五年一月, 独自看完机器人之梦

二零二五年三月, 第一次去纽约下东区廉租博物馆

读后感

脚手架纪录片小记

Caro的二十五岁生日贺卡

Caro的二十六岁生日贺卡

KLS圣诞节贺卡

A Brief Note on Christmas Trees

A Brief Reading Note?

A Brief Note on Graduating

Winter 2025, By the Brooklyn Waterfront, with Elena

In July 2021, I received a phone call from my mom telling me that my hamster had passed away. I cried all the way to Switzerland

In 2025, spotting a dilapidated chair in a hutong bearing the sign: “Godot Will Surely Come Tomorrow”

In the summer of 2024, at Columbia University, during the height of the pro-Palestinian protests, Teachers College did not suspend classes

Winter 2024, New York, the footage is now on its fifth edit

January 2025, Watched *Robot Dreams* all by myself

March 2025, My First Visit to the Tenement Museum in New York’s Lower East Side

Reading Notes

A Brief Note on a Scaffolding Documentary

Greeting Cards: Caro’s 25th Birthday

Greeting Cards: Caro’s 26th Birthday

Greeting Cards: Christmas with KLS

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我这几天一直在想我为什么一直迷恋拥有一棵圣诞树这件事，我想到我记忆所能笼络的部分中的第一棵圣诞树。我不记得我几岁了，很小，在我来北京的第一个房子里，那是一个记忆中有一点小破但是很大的房子，我对那个房子印象最深刻的是在里屋的衣柜里有一个暗门，推开暗门里面有一个带着窗户的厕所，我曾无数次设想我被关进去出不来的场景，这个衣柜迫使我无比艰辛纳尼亚传奇真的有天会发生，可能就在这个衣柜。有点扯远了，就是在这个拥有暗门厕所的房子，我拥有了第一棵圣诞树，把一棵树搬进家让他亮起灯一闪一闪的这可不是寻常事，但也有些困扰，每次去拽圣诞树上的红色小球时，总会在我手上留下一些沙子般的亮片。不知道是因为不同寻常，还是什么别的，我很喜欢这棵会发光的树，这是我第一次对圣诞树有概念，也是我最后一次在家里看到圣诞树，那应该是2003年。其实后来也并不是没有机会去买，只是在往后的冬日里，总是少了一些心血来潮与兴致，这是在百忙的日子里拥有一棵圣诞树的关键。

I have been pondering why I remain so captivated by the idea of having a Christmas tree. My thoughts drifted back to the very first Christmas tree within the scope of my earliest memories. I cannot recall how old I was, I must have been quite small, but I remember it being in the first home I lived in after moving to Beijing. It was a rather large house, albeit a bit shabby. What left the deepest impression on me was a secret door hidden inside a wardrobe in one of the inner rooms; when pushed open, it revealed a small bathroom complete with a window. I spent countless hours imagining scenarios where I might get trapped inside, unable to find my way out. That wardrobe made it agonizingly easy for me to believe that *The Chronicles of Narnia* might one day actually come true, perhaps right there, within those very doors. But I digress. It was in this very house, the one with the secret-door bathroom, that I had my first Christmas tree. Bringing a tree indoors and watching it light up, twinkling and shimmering, was no ordinary occurrence. Whether it was because of its novelty or for some other reason, I absolutely adored that glowing tree. It was the first time I ever truly grasped the concept of a Christmas tree, and, as it turned out, the last time I would ever see one inside my own home. That must have been back in 2003. In truth, there were certainly opportunities to buy one in the years that followed; it was simply that, during the winters that came after, I always seemed to lack that certain spark of spontaneity and enthusiasm, the very essence, I've come to realize, of having a Christmas tree amidst the hustle and bustle of a busy life.

我看到独属于我的困境曾经也实实在在的出现在另外一个人的另一个时空时
我曾无法比拟的孤独便有少了一分
我又原谅了自己一分
这不是什么救赎感
是感受到原来所有一切你认为独一无二的情绪都是平凡的
也有一天会融入时间的洪流中
他虽然具有时空的距离 但确实与我延迟的交汇了
这种对于我个体的重要感的削减令我安心

When I saw that the very predicament I considered uniquely my own had, in fact, tangibly manifested in another person's life—in another time and space—
The incomparable solitude I once felt diminished by a fraction.
And I forgave myself a little more.
This is not a sense of redemption.
Rather, it is the realization that all those emotions you once deemed singular and unique are, in truth, ordinary—
And that, one day, they too will dissolve into the great currents of time.
Although separated by the vast distances of time and space, that other person has indeed intersected with me—albeit with a delay.
This diminishing of my sense of individual self-importance brings me a profound sense of peace.

教育资源是否可以被平均化？作为既得利益者你是否承认你今日的优势来源于这个不平均？你想改变这种不平均是否是真心的可以接受这种平均将削弱你本身的优势，还是你想改变这一状况完全来自于一个上位者的怜悯？我带着这些问题写完了我在TC的每一个assignment，当我在毕业论文开题文档中有几近卑微的在结尾写道，“Doctor Sagolla，这是我的研究主题，如果通过了我将继续完成研究，我相信我的研究会在未来帮助博物馆最大化教育资源。”其实我完全不信，现在也不信，但我还是写了170页，四万个字。这听起来像一个懒惰悲观的理想主义者，甚至像邪教传销员。

但我很幸运，我在这碰到了一推悲观的“空想家”，大家都带着一些巨大无比的愿景，做着自己的小破烂。“我们做的东西是有意义的吗？这真的会有用吗？”这句话是我们几个在讨论论文的最后总会问的问题，最好笑的是我们都无比坚信对方的研究内容都将造福社会。我们在这种人文学生独有的集体高潮的氛围中，互相依偎渡过了这个纽约最寒冷的春天。

其实我觉得大家都不是真的相信自己能改变什么，但还是怀着不知由来的热忱洋洋洒洒的写了几万字。我们清醒地活着，但也做着美梦。我们不迎合这个社会的速度，但又朝着它生长。我们知道我们在做的可能到头来是竹篮打水一场空，但又会为篮子被洗的很干净而欢呼。但还好这次不是我，是我们。

这不是一个正常的致谢，但我想我会感谢画室门口突然出现的小脑袋，两个人扣扣搜搜的挖着一罐白颜料，桌子上来自大家的不同的小零食以度过难熬的seminar，突然出现在图书馆桌子上的全冰三分糖奶茶，一起课后咒骂教授的夜晚，和一号线地铁上从116街到59街的喜悦与不舍。感谢这些琐碎会成为一支预制的止疼药，用以抵抗未来的许多。

想对自己说，你很幸运，你遇到了很多可爱优秀的女孩子，你们互相支持，将希望和善良变成温暖的彩色射线，以理想主义为半径，向着这个看似不太妙的世界扫射。

最后“愿如风有信，长与日俱中”愿我们能如四季的风般守信，按时赴约每一场花开与叶落，也愿内心始终如正午的太阳般明亮，在时光的流转中保持温暖与坚定。

3

Can educational resources ever truly be equalized? As a beneficiary of the status quo, do you acknowledge that your current advantages stem precisely from this inequality? If you seek to rectify this imbalance, is your desire sincere—are you truly prepared to accept that such equalization might diminish your own advantages—or does your impulse to change the situation stem merely from the condescending pity of one who holds a position of privilege? I carried these questions with me as I completed every single assignment during my time at TC. In the concluding remarks of my thesis proposal, I wrote—with a tone bordering on the obsequious—“Doctor Sagolla, this is my research topic. Should it be approved, I intend to proceed with the study; I am confident that my research will, in the future, assist museums in maximizing their educational resources.” In truth, I didn’t believe a word of it—and I still don’t—yet I went on to write 170 pages, totaling 40,000 words. This makes me sound like a lazy, pessimistic idealist—or perhaps even a cult recruiter.

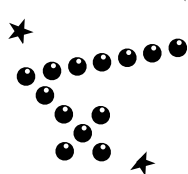
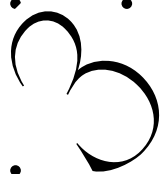
Yet, I was fortunate; here, I encountered a whole cohort of fellow pessimistic “visionaries.” Each of us harbored a colossal vision, all while toiling away on our own humble, scrappy projects. “Is what we’re doing actually meaningful? Will it ever really be useful?” This was the question we invariably asked one another at the end of every thesis discussion. The funniest part was that, while doubting our own work, we remained absolutely convinced that each other’s research would undoubtedly benefit society. Bathed in this atmosphere of collective euphoria—a state unique to students of the humanities—we huddled together for warmth, weathering the coldest spring New York had seen in years.

In truth, I suspect none of us truly believed we could change anything; yet, fueled by an inexplicable fervor, we still poured out tens of thousands of words. We live with clear-eyed sobriety, yet we dream beautiful dreams. We do not bend to the pace of this society, yet we grow toward it nonetheless. We know that our efforts may ultimately amount to nothing more than carrying water in a wicker basket—a futile endeavor—yet we would still cheer for the simple fact that the basket has been washed clean. But thankfully, this time, it was not just me; it was *us*.

This is no conventional acknowledgment, yet I feel compelled to offer my thanks: for the little heads that would suddenly pop up at the studio door; for the two of us frugally scraping the last bits from a single jar of white paint; for the assortment of snacks shared across the table to help us survive those grueling seminars; for the iced milk tea, with just three-tenths sugar, that would suddenly appear on my library desk; for the nights spent together after class, venting our frustrations about our professors; and for the mix of joy and reluctance we felt on the Line 1 subway, traveling from 116th Street down to 59th Street. I am grateful that these trivial moments will serve as a pre-made dose of pain relief, a remedy to help us withstand whatever the future may hold.

I want to tell myself: you are truly fortunate. You have met so many lovely and exceptional young women; supporting one another, you transform hope and kindness into warm, vibrant rays of color, radiating outward with idealism as your radius, and cast them across this world that, at times, seems rather bleak.

Finally: "May we be as winds that keep their word, and forever shine like the midday sun." May we remain as faithful as the winds of the four seasons, arriving right on cue for every blossoming flower and falling leaf; and may our inner selves remain as bright as the midday sun, preserving our warmth and steadfastness amidst the ceaseless flow of time.



我们都变得油腻了 坐在一起总是怀念过去
说着波士顿寒冷的冬天 河边的加拿大鹅

我们现在也在河边
我们现在也算有鹅吧 鸽子是鹅近亲

嗯算吧 其实我只是觉得现在的日子很平淡
平淡的开心和平淡的难过

我感觉我逐渐和其他人变得很像

很麻木很漠然的接受

我真的觉得18岁boylston st的我们很美好

我那时候觉得我们无所不能

现在觉得如果能过一眼望到头的日子就行了

可是我觉得24岁想法设法在世界各地

为了见面的我们也很美好

我们能见到

就说明我们无所不能

我们愿意不远万里的相聚

仍然坐在这里积极的探讨我们18岁探讨的那些

并且是更加深刻的

时间流过你我 可能带走了些对自己的期许

但水流冲过 冲出了一些鲜活明亮

让我们一眼都找到了彼此

We've both grown a bit "greasy" with age; whenever we sit together, we inevitably find ourselves reminiscing about the past. We talk of Boston's biting winters, and of the Canada Geese by the riverbank.

We are by a riverbank now, too.
I suppose you could say we have geese here, too—after all, pigeons are close cousins of geese.

Hmm, I suppose so. Though, truth be told, I just feel that life these days has become rather—flat.
A flat sort of happiness, and a flat sort of sadness.
I feel as though I am gradually becoming just like everyone else—
Accepting things with a sense of numbness, with utter indifference.
I truly feel that the "us" of eighteen—back on Boylston Street—was something beautiful.
Back then, I felt we were invincible.
Now, I feel that simply living a life where I can see the road ahead—clear to the very end—would be enough.

But I think the "us" of twenty-four—finding ways to cross the globe just to see one another—is beautiful, too.
The very fact that we *can* meet...
Proves that we are invincible.
We are willing to travel vast distances just to be together;
To sit right here, still actively discussing the very same things we discussed at eighteen—
Only now, with a far greater depth of understanding.

Time has flowed over us—over you and me—perhaps carrying away some of the expectations we once held for ourselves.
Yet, as the current rushed past, it also washed something fresh and bright to the surface—
Something that allowed us to spot one another at a single glance.



奶黄包你去吱星还顺利么，吱星的饭会不会吃的不习惯，毕竟你在我家都吃的是人饭哈哈哈哈哈。你是不是在怨我离开家一整年，你走前也没见我最后一面，你一直在怨我吧，不然怎么一点消息都不给我，都不托梦给我。

姐姐把你买回家的时候就 know 你不会陪我太久，但是你太漂亮了，我感觉我这辈子都不会碰到你这么漂亮的小盆友了，耳朵和手指都是粉粉的，吃东西的时候会很享受的把大眼睛闭起来，缩成一个小球，每次吃不完的好吃的还要塞进嘴里打包带走，虽然脾气很差但是看在你那么好看还陪我上了一年凌晨网课的份上，我原谅你了呀

我以为你至少能等到我回国，冬天，再看一次北京的雪再离开，我还在淘宝收藏了仓鼠可以带的小帽子，是粉色的，我都能想到你带着她有多好看

那天早上妈妈跟我说你去吱星了，我一瞬间觉得你一定是在骗我，我还让妈妈捅了捅你，才接受你真的走了，为什么这么着急呢，等我半年我就回去了呀，是不是上次我俩开的时候说明年夏天见，但我却毁约了，你生气了，你不要我了。你怎么老了脾气还这么大呀

我还记得我们第一次见面我去机场接你，你在那个四方的小正方形盒子里不停的动，后来住进我家后，我每次给你收拾窝我都把你放在那个小盒子里，你每次都粘一身木屑，后来凌晨上网课，我把你放在那个你来时的盒子里，端上我的书桌，然后趁机撸你占你便宜，虽然你很烦但也没有办法阻止我。但是为什么我再看见你在那个四方形的盒子里时，你已经把眼睛闭上了，耳朵也不再是粉色，毛发无光的躺在那里僵硬的一动不动，你好像只长大了一点点，那个方形的小盒子依然放的下你，只是这次你很安静，不想来的时候把那个盒子咬出一个洞

奶黄包，回来看看我吧，我真的很想你，给我托个梦也行，没有遵守诺言夏天见面是我的错，我也没有想到我的计划不停的再变，我很后悔去欧洲前没有跟妈妈视频的时候看看你，以后我们常见面吧只要你想，我们梦里见，在吱星伙食肯定没有在家里好，你可以跟我抱怨的，我给你传送一点好吃的食物。奶黄包，在吱星要好好的，不要贪玩把嘴巴磨破，不要再把食物藏在厕所里，请继续做一个富婆美女吧。

5

Naihuangbao, did your journey to the “Squeak Star” go smoothly? Is the food there taking some getting used to? After all, while you were living with me, you were used to eating “human food”—hahaha! Are you holding a grudge against me for being away from home for a whole year? You didn’t even get to see me one last time before you left. You must be angry with me—otherwise, why haven’t you sent me a single sign? Why haven’t you even visited me in my dreams?

When I first brought you home, I knew you wouldn’t be with me for very long. But you were just so beautiful; I felt certain I’d never meet another little creature as lovely as you in my entire life. Your ears and tiny fingers were a delicate shade of pink; whenever you ate, you’d close your big, bright eyes in sheer bliss and curl yourself up into a tiny little ball. You’d even stuff any leftovers into your cheeks to “pack away for later.” Although you had quite a grumpy temperament, I’ve forgiven you—partly because you were just so adorable, and partly because you kept me company through a whole year of late-night online classes.

I thought you would at least wait until I returned home, until winter, so you could see the snow in Beijing one last time before you left. I even had a tiny hat for hamsters bookmarked on Taobao. A little pink one. I could picture exactly how adorable you would look wearing it.

That morning, Mom told me you had gone to “Squeak-Star.” For a split second, I felt certain she must be lying to me; I even made her give you a gentle nudge before I could finally accept that you were truly gone. Why were you in such a rush? If you had just waited for me for another six months, I would have been back home. Was it because the last time we said goodbye, we promised to see each other next summer—but then I broke that promise? Did you get angry? Did you decide you didn’t want me anymore? Why did you still have such a big temper, even in your old age?

I still remember the first time we met, when I went to the airport to pick you up; you were squirming around non-stop inside that little square box. Later, after you moved into our home, whenever I cleaned out your cage, I would place you back inside that same little box—and every time, you’d end up covered in wood shavings. Later still, when I had online classes in the wee hours of the morning, I would put you in that box you arrived in, set it right on my desk, and seize the opportunity to pet you and shower you with affection. You found it annoying, but there was nothing you could do to stop me. But why is it that when I saw you in that square box again, your eyes were already closed? Your ears were no longer pink; your fur had lost its luster, and you lay there—stiff and motionless. It seemed as though you had barely grown at all; that little square box could still hold you perfectly. Only this time, you were completely silent—unlike when you first arrived, when you tried to chew a hole right through it.

Naihuangbao, please come back and visit me—I miss you so much. Even just visiting me in a dream would be enough. It was my fault that we didn’t keep our promise to meet this summer; I never anticipated that my plans would keep changing the way they did. I deeply regret not taking the chance to see you during my video call with Mom before I left for Europe. Let’s make sure to see each other often from now on—whenever you’d like. We can meet in our dreams. I bet the food over in “Zhi-Star” isn’t nearly as good as it was back home; feel free to complain to me about it, and I’ll send some tasty treats your way. Naihuangbao, please take good care of yourself over in Zhi-Star. Don’t get so carried away playing that you scrape your mouth raw again, and please stop hiding your food in the bathroom! Just keep being the beautiful, pampered princess you are.

贝克特所处的战后欧洲，正是这一转变的临界点。宏大叙事的崩塌，使人逐渐失去对历史进步、理性秩序与人类主体性的信任。后来被称为后现代的思想，将意义视为一种可被解构的结构，将价值视为一种可被揭示为“刻奇”的幻象。《等待戈多》恰恰停留在这一断裂尚未完全完成的瞬间：意义已经无法被确认，但也尚未被彻底放弃；信念已经动摇，但仍未消失。

昆德拉在《庆祝无意义》中所提出的姿态——当人不再执着于意义本身，而转向“庆祝无意义”，某种意义上，等待就被终止了。因为等待的前提，是相信意义仍有可能在未来显现；而一旦无意义被彻底接受，等待本身便失去了必要性。从这个角度看，“庆祝无意义”仿佛是一种已经等到戈多之后的状态——不是因为戈多真的到来，而是因为人不再需要他。

贝克特的姿态并非单纯的虚无主义。他在剧中如此强烈地呈现等待的荒诞，并不只是为了否定意义，而更像是在揭示人类仍然无法停止对意义的渴望。荒诞并没有终结等待，反而使等待更加清晰可见。他似乎并未完全接受后现代那种彻底的解构立场，而仍然保留着某种现代主义式的执念——相信艺术仍可以作为一次重新探索意义的行动，而不仅仅是对意义的嘲讽或拆解。

因此，《等待戈多》最终并没有给出答案。它没有证明戈多会来，也没有证明戈多不会来。它只是让等待持续存在。而在这种持续之中，人既无法彻底绝望，也无法彻底确信希望。我们或许永远没有证据断言，明天戈多一定不会来。

我始终倾向于认为，戈多或许永远不会来。但真正重要的并不是戈多是否到来，而是人们始终相信他会来这一事实本身。换句话说，意义并不存在于“到来”的事件之中，而存在于“等待”的结构之中。不确定性并未摧毁信念，反而成为信念得以生成的条件。正是在无法确认结果的前提下，人仍然选择继续等待，而这种在悬置之中维持希望的状态，比抵达某个确定的终点更加困难，也更加珍贵。等待不再只是通往意义的手段，而成为意义自身的形式。

The post-war Europe in which Beckett lived marked the critical juncture of this very transformation. The collapse of grand narratives caused people to gradually lose their faith in historical progress, rational order, and human subjectivity. The school of thought later termed “postmodernism” came to view meaning as a structure open to deconstruction, and value as an illusion that could be exposed as mere “kitsch”. *Waiting for Godot* is situated precisely at that fleeting moment when this rupture remained incomplete: meaning could no longer be affirmed, yet neither had it been entirely abandoned; faith had been shaken, yet it had not yet vanished.

Consider the stance proposed by Kundera in *The Festival of Insignificance*: when one ceases to obsess over meaning itself and turns instead to “celebrating insignificance,” the act of waiting—in a certain sense—comes to an end. For the very premise of waiting is the belief that meaning might still manifest in the future; once insignificance is fully embraced, the act of waiting itself loses its necessity. Viewed from this perspective, “celebrating insignificance” resembles a state achieved after one has finally waited for Godot—not because Godot has actually arrived, but because one no longer has any need for him.

Beckett’s stance is not one of mere nihilism. In his plays, his intense portrayal of the absurdity of waiting serves not merely to negate meaning, but rather to reveal that humanity remains unable to cease its yearning for it. The absurd does not bring waiting to an end; on the contrary, it renders the act of waiting all the more vivid and visible. He appears not to have fully embraced the radical deconstructive stance characteristic of postmodernism, but rather to have retained a certain modernist tenacity—a belief that art can still function as an act of re-exploring meaning, rather than serving merely as a vehicle for its mockery or dismantling.

Consequently, *Waiting for Godot* ultimately offers no answers. It neither proves that Godot will arrive, nor proves that he will not. It simply allows the act of waiting to persist. And within this persistence, human beings are left unable to succumb to absolute despair, yet equally unable to embrace absolute certainty of hope. We may, perhaps, never possess the evidence to assert with absolute certainty that Godot will not arrive tomorrow.

I have always tended to believe that Godot may never arrive. Yet, what truly matters is not whether Godot arrives, but the very fact that people continue to believe he will. In other words, meaning resides not in the event of “arrival,” but in the structure of “waiting.” Uncertainty does not destroy belief; rather, it serves as the very condition under which belief is generated. It is precisely against the backdrop of an unconfirmable outcome that one chooses to persist in waiting—a state of sustaining hope amidst suspension that is both more arduous and more precious than reaching any definitive destination. Waiting ceases to be merely a means to meaning; it becomes the very form of meaning itself.

是的，哥大的抗议和游行已经第九天了，我对这件事一开始是没有关注的，我认为他会像其它的抗议一样只有几个小时的寿命，我从来没有现场的经历过一个持续多天的抗议。

这几天我和我的中国朋友们聊的最多的问题就是他们为什么这么拼，为什么接近零度要睡在室外的地上，为什么不能洗澡也要驻扎在那里呐喊口号，明明大家都是所谓的精英和所谓的富家子弟，怎么愿意吃这个苦，最后我们得出的结论是可能真的到了国家存亡之际了。

是啊我们这生活在和平里的一代，如何去感受一个民族的存亡之际呢。纵然我们看来许多的文学作品，影视作品，但是我一直认为除非真的亲身经历，不然不会有感同身受一说，同理心和换位思考是最大的谎言。

上周，我一出地铁就被卷进了抗议的队伍里面，我没有办法抽身，所以跟着人群走了一段，就是这一段突然让我对这件事有了实感，我好像突然明白人五四运动走上街的青年，好像明白了一些不能说的抗议为什么可以持续，为什么年轻人愿意弃自己的前程于不顾，那是一种鼓舞人心的气氛我无法用语言描述但是一起走的这几分钟，我在心里真心希望星星之火可以燎原，虽然我从不相信这句话。

这周因为警察冲进校园抓走学生，nyu，哥大，宾大的教授们穿着自己的博士服走进校园，他们手拉着手变成了一道人墙，他们站在这里的原因和学生们不一样，他们只是为了保护自己的学生，那一幕特别像哈利波特终极之战的时候，所有的教授都拿着自己的魔杖冲在学生的前面。所有人都在这一刻有自己想维护的东西或者人，原来人之间的情感是具有流动性的，原来我们身处的每一天在未来都会成为历史，原来我们都身处于不断发展但同时也不断循环的历史洪流中。

今天，我的美国同学问我你怎么看这件事，我说我没有资格评价任何一方，因为我不知道事情的全貌，我也没有经历过任何一方的立场与苦难。我从出生开始就没有受过苦难，作为旁观者我有的只是心疼，我知道政权和世界的进步，财富的创造全都来源于矛盾，国家和国家之间的矛盾。世界和平从来都是伪命题。就像当念苏联和美国冷战的时候，他们是真的要冷战吗，当让不是，如果一个假想敌可以带来数以亿计的经济成果，真成为敌人又有什么用呢？我心疼的是无数的平凡的普通人被这个时代，被这些政治所裹挟，做出反抗，但其实都是高级政客的把戏罢了。换成是我，我不会去抗议，但我从心里面敬佩他们。

希望接下来的一周不要有人受伤，希望他们可以守护住他们想守护的东西

7

Indeed, the protests and demonstrations at Columbia have now entered their ninth day. Initially, I paid little attention to the matter; I assumed it would be like any other protest—short-lived, lasting only a few hours. I had never before witnessed a protest that persisted for multiple days.

Over the past few days, the topic my Chinese friends and I have discussed most frequently is this: Why are they so committed? Why are they willing to sleep on the ground outdoors in near-freezing temperatures? Why do they remain camped out there, chanting slogans, even without the ability to shower? After all, these are supposedly the “elite”—the so-called children of privilege—so how can they be willing to endure such hardship? Ultimately, the conclusion we reached was that, for them, this may truly be a moment of national existential crisis.

Yes—for us, a generation living in peacetime, how can we possibly grasp the gravity of a nation facing an existential threat? Although we have consumed countless works of literature and film, I have always maintained that unless one experiences something firsthand, true “empathy” is impossible; the very concepts of empathy and “putting oneself in another’s shoes” are, in my view, the greatest of lies.

Last week, the moment I stepped out of the subway station, I was swept up into a protest march. Unable to extricate myself, I walked along with the crowd for a while. It was during this brief stretch that the reality of the situation suddenly hit me. I felt as though I suddenly understood the young people who took to the streets during the May Fourth Movement; I seemed to grasp why certain—often unspoken—protests can persist, and why young people are willing to cast aside their own futures without a second thought. It was an inspiring atmosphere—one I cannot adequately describe in words—but during those few minutes of walking together, I found myself sincerely hoping, deep down, that “a single spark can start a prairie fire”—even though I have never truly believed in that saying before.

This week, after police stormed university campuses to arrest students, professors from NYU, Columbia, and Penn donned their doctoral robes and marched onto their grounds. Holding hands, they formed a human wall. Their reasons for standing there differed from those of the students; they were there simply to protect their own pupils. The scene bore a striking resemblance to the final battle in *Harry Potter*, where all the professors rushed to the front lines, wands in hand, to shield the students. In that moment, everyone present had something—or someone—they wished to defend. It dawned on me that the bonds between human beings possess a fluid, dynamic nature; that every day we live through will, in time, become history; and that we are all, in fact, immersed in a ceaseless torrent of history—one that is constantly evolving, yet simultaneously repeating itself in cycles.

Today, an American classmate asked me for my take on the situation. I replied that I am not qualified to pass judgment on either side, for I do not possess the full picture of events, nor have I personally experienced the perspectives or hardships faced by either party. I have lived a life free of suffering since birth; as a mere bystander, all I feel is a deep sense of heartache. I recognize that the advancement of political regimes and the world at large—as well as the creation of wealth—all stem from conflict: specifically, the conflicts that arise between nations. The notion of “world peace” has always been a fallacy. Consider, for instance, the Cold War between the Soviet Union and the United States: did they genuinely desire a state of perpetual conflict? Of course not. Yet, if the existence of a “hypothetical enemy” can generate hundreds of millions in economic returns, what does it matter if that enemy becomes a reality? What truly breaks my heart is seeing countless ordinary, everyday people swept up by the currents of this era and the machinations of politics—compelled to rise up in resistance, only to find that it is all merely a game played by high-level politicians. Were I in their shoes, I would not take to the streets to protest; yet, deep within my heart, I hold them in the highest esteem.

I hope that in the week ahead, no one suffers injury, and that everyone succeeds in safeguarding the things they hold dear.

观看我拍的东西发现我总是有一个毛病，不管是拍景色还是拍人，我很固执的站在一个遥远的地方，一个角落在注视，我从没有一次挤进他们，然后让胳膊衣服人流帮我重新整理规矩的16:9的画幅，让烟火气覆盖在我的镜头上，我不知道我对自己机制的客体性也会附着在我的记录上，下次会试试在往前走一步的。

Reviewing my work, I’ve discovered a persistent habit of mine: whether filming landscapes or people, I stubbornly position myself at a distance—watching from a corner. Never once have I pushed my way into the midst of the scene, allowing the tangle of arms, clothing, and passing crowds to organically reframe the rigid 16:9 aspect ratio, or letting the raw, vibrant energy of life settle upon my lens. I hadn’t realized that my own ingrained sense of detachment—of viewing the world as a mere object—would inevitably imprint itself upon my documentation. Next time, I’ll try taking one step closer.

好难过 看机器人之梦里面纽约地铁的画面
突然想到如果很多年后我再回ny还能不能不看导航坐地铁 我应该会记得每天上学从e或者r在42街导1的上学路吧
但我又突然想到之前在波士顿住gh也每天坐地铁上学 甚至是直达 但我完全不记得自己做了哪条线只记得是绿线 记忆原来也转瞬即逝, 也才过了两年。

It upset me to see the scenes of the New York subway in the film. It suddenly occurred to me: if I were to return to NYC many years from now, would I still be able to navigate the subway without relying on a map? I imagine I'd still remember my daily commute to school, transferring from the E or R train to the 1 train at 42nd Street. But then another thought struck me: I used to live in GH in Boston and took the subway to school every day back then, too—it was even a direct route. Yet now, I can't remember which specific line I took at all; I only recall that it was the Green Line. It turns out memories really are fleeting. And that was only two years ago.

The Tenement Museum的叙事逻辑由一个人或者一个小家庭展开, 从个人的家庭叙事, 到个人遇到的困难和成就作为基础慢慢放大到社会的情况, 当你已经与这些普通的“小人物们”建立情感链接, 代入了他们的处境的时候, 叙事逐渐转变为更宽的对于社会制度, 情况, 法律的等的描述, 在这种我已经带入那些人物的情况下, 我可以更好的理解当时的历史, 也可以非常共情历史的一个小小的改变落在他们每个小小的个体身上就会变成重担和巨变的无奈, 这种叙事逻辑将普通人物的故事作为一个窥探宏大历史的窗口, 增加参观者的代入感, 让历史从一种漂浮的知识变成一种实际的处境, 在这种情况下, 参观者会更engage在历史故事中, 而不是作为一个只是参观的客体。

The narrative logic of the Tenement Museum unfolds through the lens of a single individual or a small family unit. It begins with a personal domestic narrative—grounded in the specific hardships and triumphs encountered by that individual—and gradually expands outward to illuminate broader societal conditions. Once you have forged an emotional connection with these ordinary “little people” and fully immersed yourself in their circumstances, the narrative gradually shifts to offer a wider-ranging description of the social systems, conditions, and laws of the era. With myself already deeply invested in the lives of these characters, I was able to gain a far deeper understanding of the historical context of the time. Moreover, I could deeply empathize with the sense of helplessness—the realization that even a minor historical shift could descend upon each of these humble individuals as an overwhelming burden and a seismic upheaval in their lives. This narrative approach utilizes the stories of ordinary people as a window through which to glimpse the grand sweep of history; it heightens the visitor's sense of immersion, transforming history from a body of abstract, floating knowledge into a tangible, lived reality. In doing so, visitors become more deeply engaged with the historical narratives, rather than remaining mere passive observers.

读后感

《众灵日》

我对阿图尔的偏爱是从知道他也是个爱在街上闲逛乱想，并想把自己看到的拍成纪录片开始。读者总会怜爱与自己相似的人物，阿图尔拍拍光告再拍拍纪录片的生活具像化了我的理想高地。他在记忆的废墟上用新的认知筑楼，远看却也只剩狂想搬的荒诞，踩着历史走路是一场巨大的刻舟求剑，以活人的立场见证众人信仰的死亡最深刻的一次，他有朋友，但是他的孤独没有朋友，这给了他无尽的孤独，但同时也给了他感知众灵的能力，柏林负雪，众灵环绕。

《克林索尔的最后夏天》

我一直觉得我的朋友们虽然来自不同的地方，但总是有一种难以言说的非常吸引我的特性，今天终于明白原来是“候鸟性”，他们坚韧的飞了很远却在特定的时间归来看望我，诉说着旅途的趣闻与精彩，再马不停蹄的飞往下次遇见，我没有候鸟性，我不爱出远门我也不够勇敢，可能这是为什么这种特性对我格外charming的原因。虽然我期盼了很久这位叫克林索尔的画家的故事，但我并不喜欢，因为黑塞对格尔德蒙的塑造让我坚信我会爱让他笔下的每一个艺术家，但现实是克林索尔先生我恐怕是个没有深度的人所以我难以共情与你，我更希望你在每个南方的夏日感受酸面包与勃艮第陪着歌舞的微醺，哪怕盛大的夏日之后是你所说的某种陨落，这并不应该是克林索尔的最后夏天。

《金阁寺》

终于读完了。虽然一共只读了四个小时但跨越了四个月，我无法理解沟口以及三岛由纪夫独特的日式物哀美学，我的阅读速度和兴趣在鹤川死后也逐渐消磨。或许我期许我读的文学作品中一定要有个乌托邦式的人物或者空间，但这唯一的喘息带着沟口为数不多的天真美好也死了，变成了深山老林中潮湿可怖的一种蕨类，但我同意那句“烧死我的大火也能烧毁金阁”人类与人类文明的不灭不具有意义，当我意识到我无比期待在结尾看到大火中对于金阁的描写的时候我真切感受到了那句比巴黎圣母院更美的是燃烧的巴黎圣母院，但我并未如愿，但我也惊讶于我的期待。原来我也更期待看到美好毁掉壮观场景。“你所喜欢的美的东西，只是人的精神中委托于认识的残存部分、剩余部分的幻影。”金阁寺是一场巨大的祛魅文学，但你也确实让我读的好辛苦。

Reading Notes

All Souls' Day

My fondness for Artur began the moment I learned that he, too, was someone who loved to wander the streets lost in thought—someone who aspired to capture what he saw and transform it into documentary film. Readers invariably harbor a soft spot for characters who mirror themselves; Artur's life—spent alternating between shooting commercials and filming documentaries—serves as the concrete embodiment of my own idealized aspirations. Upon the ruins of memory, he constructs new edifices of understanding; yet, viewed from a distance, the result appears as nothing more than an absurdity bordering on delusion. To walk upon the terrain of history is to engage in a monumental act of futile anachronism—a desperate attempt to apply fixed coordinates to a constantly shifting reality. From the vantage point of the living, he bears witness to the most profound demise of collective faith. He has friends, yet his solitude has none; this leaves him steeped in an infinite loneliness, while simultaneously endowing him with the capacity to perceive the presence of all souls. Berlin lies blanketed in snow, and all souls gather round.

Klingsor's Last Summer

I have always felt that, despite hailing from diverse backgrounds, my friends share a certain indefinable quality that holds a profound allure for me. Today, I finally realized what it is: a “migratory nature.” With unyielding resilience, they fly great distances, yet at specific times they return to visit me—recounting the anecdotes and wonders of their journeys—before flying off once more, without pause, toward their next encounter. I do not possess this migratory nature; I have no love for distant travel, nor am I brave enough. Perhaps this is precisely why this particular trait strikes me as so extraordinarily charming. Although I had long awaited the story of this painter named Klingsor, I found I did not care for it. Hesse's masterful portrayal of Goldmund had led me to believe—with absolute certainty—that I would fall in love with every artist he brought to life with his pen. Yet the reality is, I fear Mr. Klingsor, that you are a man lacking in depth; consequently, I find myself unable to empathize with you. I would have much preferred to see you savoring every southern summer—accompanied by sourdough bread and Burgundy wine, basking in the gentle tipsiness of song and dance. For even if that magnificent summer were to be followed by the “fall” you spoke of, it ought not to have been Klingsor's last summer.

The Temple of the Golden Pavilion

I have finally finished reading it. Although the total reading time amounted to only four hours, it spanned a period of four months. I find myself unable to fully grasp the unique Japanese aesthetic

of “mono no aware”—that poignant sensitivity to the transience of things—as embodied by Mizoguchi and Yukio Mishima. Both my reading pace and my interest gradually waned following the death of Tsurukawa. Perhaps I harbor an expectation that the literary works I read must contain some utopian figure or space; yet, that sole respite—carrying with it the few vestiges of innocence and beauty that Mizoguchi possessed—died along with him, transforming into a damp, ghastly fern deep within the remote wilderness. Nevertheless, I resonate with the sentiment: “The great fire that consumes me can also consume the Golden Pavilion.” The indestructibility of humanity—and of human civilization—is devoid of meaning. When I realized how intensely I anticipated reading a description of the Golden Pavilion engulfed in flames during the book’s finale, I truly grasped the truth behind the adage: “The only thing more beautiful than Notre Dame is Notre Dame in flames.” Yet, my wish went unfulfilled—though I was, in turn, astonished by my own expectation; it turns out that I, too, was secretly yearning to witness the spectacular scene of beauty being destroyed. “The beautiful things you cherish are merely phantoms—the residual fragments, the remnants of the human spirit entrusted to the realm of perception.” *The Temple of the Golden Pavilion* stands as a monumental work of literary disenchantment—yet, you certainly made for a grueling read.

一开始, 我只是想拍一个newyork newyork thing, 我想拍地铁里的大老鼠, 我也想拍ny的餐车, 我拼命搜寻什么东西是只有纽约有, 并且有很多的, 百老汇的剧院, 博物馆, 这些东西太宏大了, 太漂浮了, 他当然可以代表纽约, 待这绝不是独属于我的眼里的纽约, 后面我想拍ny的bar们, 这个想法在我去完第一个bar喝了一杯cocktail红成tomato后放弃了, 这也不是我的纽约。

我是个下雨从不带伞的人, 不是装酷, 哪怕伞放在门口, 我十有八九也会忘记拿, 这个陋习源于我有一个对待生活十分周全且非常照顾人的妈。九月中的一天, 我又忘带伞了, 当我祈祷雨不要下大的时候, 下大了。我在50街抱头鼠窜躲到了一个脚手架下面, 遇到了一群和我一样没带伞的人, 我们都冲对方尴尬的笑笑, 也庆幸这里有个脚手架。诶! 脚手架! 这definitely是一个New York New York thing!

整个9月和10月我像老鼠一样从wall street开始寻觅记录各种各样的脚手架一直到125街, 我和我的破sony从那天起就穿梭在纽约这个城市, 我很久没有举起相机密集记录一件事物, 上一次是18岁还学电影的时候, 老师让拍one thing special about Boston, 我跟着加拿大鹅拍了一个月, 我记得他们都是以双数出现, 有的鹅可以生8个崽, 有的鹅只能生2个。

扯远了, 总之那段时间我魔障了, 我的朋友也。凡是看到脚手架拆卸的比发信息告诉我, 我有时候脸也没来得及洗就赶去地点, 我总觉得我还能拍到更好的。现在回想起来, 那些镜头我全都没用上。我所有引以为傲的镜头瞬间全是不期而遇。十月初coer来纽约期中考试, 我陪她在五道shopping, 拍到了刚搭起来的LV脚手架。某天去nyu图书馆接夏夏, 拍到了一个像是寻梦环游记主题风格的脚手架和一个把脚手架当家的流浪汉(他甚至给自己搞了茶几和台灯)。又或者那天我真的很想吃中国城Kings Kitchen的煲仔饭, 然后遇到了一个摆摊卖衣服的中国大姨直接把衣服挂在了脚手架上。还有那天和Caroline一起在西村溜达, 拍到了很多穿过脚手架依然蓬勃生长的绿色植物, 以及federal hall前面把George Washington围起来的脚手架。还有一天我和Chelsea在soho逛街一抬头我发现脚手架上钉了一个牌子上面写着: shyness steals your life, group classes NYC, unshyness.com for everybody. (害羞偷走你的生活, 小组课程, 和我们一起不要害羞!)

我在记录脚手架吗, 不, 我其实在记录24岁在ny生活的东子(ok没错是我

的艺名)；以及东子和她的高中同学, 东子和她的大学同学, 东子和她的研究生同学。

我没想投奖, 我只想把它拍完, 就像是我最喜欢的纪录片导演John Wilson做一个ny城市观察者, 适当的吐槽两句但仍然走在ny街头举着相机迈过街上人不知源头的排泄物。但当我听到教授和我说这个奖的主题是Serendipity的时候, 我回想拍摄过程突然觉得诶, 一切的一切都很贴合, 尽管我认为Serendipity十分的陈词滥调, 但或许是ny的生活过于的无法掌控, 所以我完全不期待任何好事的发生, 在这种预设下, 这个片子的大部分镜头确实实是一些不期而遇的惊喜。

我从来没有identify我自己是个艺术家, 但我有很多个搞艺术的盆友, 他们都和我说搞艺术是痛苦的, 我说那不能, 我看你们的作品我挺快乐的, 然后我这次就体会到了痛苦, 当然比起他们我是直观浅显的痛苦, 就是我非常不喜欢来来回回改我这个片子就为了参加这个奖, 我来来回回看, 来来回回改, 我改了12个版本出来, 当我打下12的时候, 我突然理解这些年我看我爸站在他的油画前一遍遍的看, 一遍遍的覆盖, 原来是这这么个意思, artist gaze是吧, 但我真gaze不了一点, 提交作品后直到今日收到消息我的作品被select了, 我才重新打开了这个视频, 捂着耳朵又看了一遍。朋友问我说, 怎么着, 东子之后不搞marketing了吧, 做回文艺工作者了, 我说做不了一点, 还是marketing这种浮躁浅显的东西比较适合我。

坦白说看到我的片子in了这件事儿还是挺开心的, 毕竟有1000刀奖金, 也浅浅和19岁在波士顿秋天查尔斯河边追加拿大鹅的自己遥相呼应了一下, 但经此一事我想明白了, 我还是更喜欢做观众, 欣赏别人的艺术劳动与创作成果, 在不知道任何背景的情况下小声的蚰蚰他们, 又或者为一些难得的情感链接感动流泪, 还是看现成的快乐, 希望我的艺术家朋友们继续再接再厉, 再创辉煌

At first, I simply wanted to film a quintessential “New York, New York” piece. I wanted to capture the giant rats in the subway, and I wanted to film the city’s food trucks. I scoured the city frantically, searching for things that were unique to New York—and abundant. Broadway theaters, museums—these things felt too grand, too ethereal. While they certainly represent New York, they were by no means the New York seen through my eyes alone. Later, I thought about filming New York’s bars; however, I abandoned that idea after visiting just one bar and downing a single cocktail, which left me blushing bright red, like a tomato. That wasn’t *my* New York, either.

I am the kind of person who never carries an umbrella when it rains—not to look cool, mind you, but simply because I’m forgetful. Even if an umbrella is sitting right by the door, nine times out of ten, I’ll walk right past it. This bad habit stems from the fact that I have a mother who is incredibly meticulous about life and always looks out for everyone else. One day in mid-September, I forgot my umbrella yet again. Just as I was praying the rain wouldn’t pick up, it started pouring. Clutching my head, I scurried for cover beneath a stretch of scaffolding on 50th Street. There, I encountered a small crowd of people—all, like me, caught in the rain without an umbrella. We exchanged awkward smiles, all of us grateful that the scaffolding was there. *Aha!* Scaffolding! *That* is definitely a “New York, New York” thing!

Throughout September and October, I scurried around like a mouse—starting from Wall Street and working my way up to 125th Street—seeking out and documenting every variety of scaffolding I could find. From that day forward, my trusty, beat-up Sony camera and I became fixtures crisscrossing the city of New York. It had been a long time since I had last picked up a camera to document a single subject with such intense focus; the last time was when I was eighteen and studying film, when a teacher assigned us to capture “one thing special about Boston.” Back then, I spent a whole month following Canadian geese. I remember that they always appeared in pairs—some geese would hatch as many as eight goslings, while others would have only two.

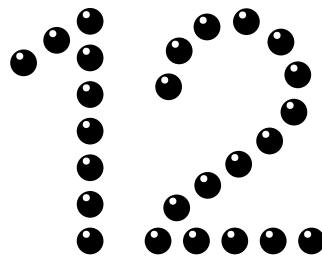
But I’m getting sidetracked. In short, during that period, I became completely obsessed—and so did my friends. Whenever anyone spotted scaffolding being dismantled, they would immediately text me to let me know. Sometimes, I would rush to the location without even having time to wash my face; I was always convinced that I could capture an even better shot. Looking back now, I realize I didn’t end up using any of those specific shots. In the end, every single image I took pride in turned out to be a completely serendipitous encounter. In early October, Coer came to New York for her midterm exams; while accompanying her shopping in the West Village, I captured the scaffolding that had just been erected around the LV store. Another day, while heading

to the NYU library to pick up Xiaxia, I came across a scaffolding structure that looked like something straight out of **Coco**—along with a homeless man who had made the scaffolding his home (he had even set himself up with a coffee table and a lamp). Then there was the day I had a serious craving for the clay-pot rice at Kings Kitchen in Chinatown; while I was there, I encountered a Chinese **ayi** selling clothes from a street stall who had simply hung her entire inventory directly onto the scaffolding. And the day Caroline and I were strolling through the West Village, I captured images of lush greenery still thriving as it grew right through the scaffolding, as well as the scaffolding encasing the statue of George Washington in front of Federal Hall. Finally, there was the day Chelsea and I were shopping in SoHo; I happened to look up and noticed a sign nailed to the scaffolding that read: “Shyness steals your life. Group classes NYC. Unshyness.com—for everybody.” (Don’t let shyness steal your life; join our group classes in NYC and let’s overcome shyness together!)

Am I documenting a scaffolding project? No—actually, I’m documenting Dongzi at age 24, living in New York City (yes, that is indeed my stage name); specifically, Dongzi alongside her high school classmates, her college classmates, and her graduate school classmates.

I never intended to submit this for an award; I simply wanted to finish filming it—much like my favorite documentary filmmaker, John Wilson, acting as an urban observer in New York: offering the occasional wry commentary while walking the city streets, camera in hand, stepping carefully over unidentifiable piles of waste. However, when my professor mentioned that the theme of this particular award was “Serendipity,” I reflected on the filming process and suddenly thought: **Hey, everything actually fits perfectly.** Although I generally find the concept of serendipity to be a bit of a cliché, perhaps it is precisely because life in New York feels so utterly beyond one’s control—leaving me with absolutely no expectation that anything good will ever happen—that, against this backdrop of low expectations, the vast majority of the footage in this film turned out to be, quite genuinely, a series of unexpected surprises.

I’ve never identified myself as an artist, though I have plenty of friends who are. They’ve all told me that making art is a painful process. I used to push back, saying, “Surely not! I feel nothing but joy when I look at your work.” But this time, I finally experienced that pain firsthand—though, compared to them, my suffering was likely quite visceral and superficial. It simply boiled down to the fact that I absolutely loathed having to endlessly revise my film just to submit it for this award. I watched it over and over, tweaking it again and again, until I had churned out twelve different versions. When I typed out that number—“12”—it suddenly hit me: I finally understood what I’d been watching my father do



all these years—standing before his oil paintings, gazing at them repeatedly, painting over them time and again. **That** is what it’s all about. The “artist’s gaze,” right? Well, let me tell you: I simply do not possess that gaze—not one bit. After submitting the piece, I didn’t dare open the video again until today, when I received the news that my work had been selected; only then did I reopen the file and watch it one last time—with my hands clamped over my ears. A friend asked me, “So, Dongzi—does this mean you’re done with marketing? Are you going back to being a creative?” I replied, “Absolutely not. I couldn’t handle it. I think I’m much better suited to something as superficial and fast-paced as marketing.”

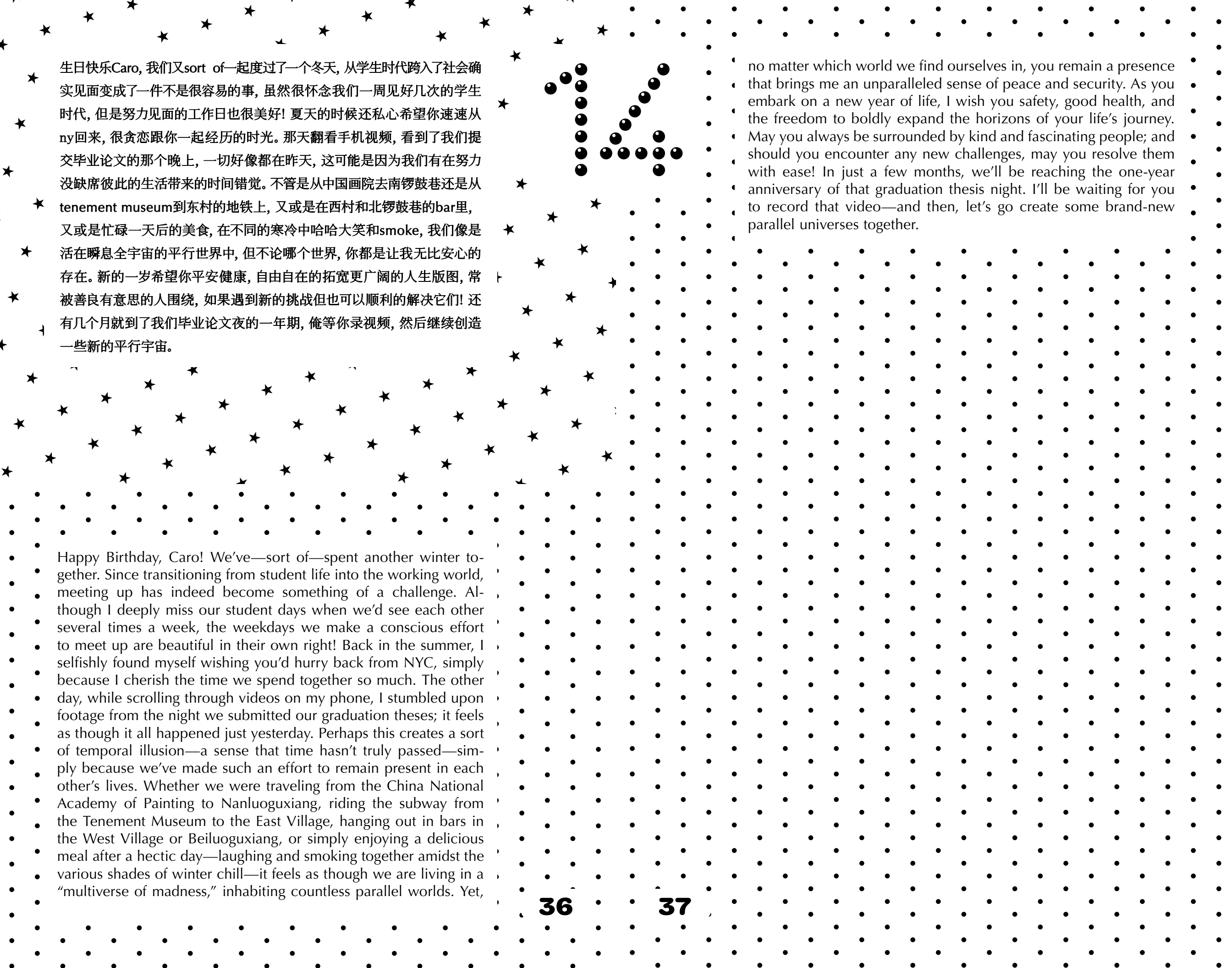
To be honest, I was pretty happy to see that my film got accepted. After all, there’s a \$1,000 prize involved, and it felt like a subtle echo of my 19-year-old self—back in Boston during the autumn, by the banks of the Charles River—when I managed to snag a Canada Goose jacket. But having gone through this experience, I’ve come to a realization: I much prefer being a spectator—admiring the artistic labor and creative output of others, quietly critiquing them under my breath without knowing any of the backstory, or shedding tears over those rare, moving emotional connections. I simply prefer the effortless joy of consuming art rather than creating it. I hope my artist friends will keep up the great work and go on to achieve even greater heights.

生日快乐。愿你始终以温柔、平和而坚定的方式去爱、去感知、去创造，在世界的细微与广阔之间保持敏锐的探索：既能捕捉那些抽象而流动的瞬间，也能真实地触碰生活里具体而微的存在。那天和你聊乐观这件事，我说自己是乐观的，我没说的是你是我乐观的原因之一。让我们继续举杯，toast到下一个冬天，toast到那些还未发生却已经被期待的时刻，甚至toast到某种不合时宜却足够浪漫的愿望。一起解锁人生的新场景，你去看更大的世界，我也在与你的路径中不断延展自己；大胆地去感受，让情绪完整地流经我们，而不是被规训或消解。新的一年，我们会在剧场、studio、bar、画廊、影院，甚至某一趟地铁里再次相遇——相逢、过冬，又一起与一年告别。我希望在彼此的生命剧本里，我们都是常驻演员，在不同的时刻反复认出那种熟悉的欢喜。继续幻想吧，让思想与对话像发酵一样不断生长，像某种不知疲倦的能量，使人生逐渐变得有层次、有回声。所有的困扰都会留在过去的一岁里，如果年龄的增长带来一丝不安，那就把它当作命运给予的精神补偿——提醒你更用力地去幸福，因为每一个冬天的句号，终究都会通向春天。

Happy Birthday. May you always love, perceive, and create with a spirit that is gentle, peaceful, and steadfast—maintaining a keen sense of exploration amidst both the subtle nuances and the vast expanses of the world: capable of capturing those abstract and fluid moments, while also genuinely touching upon the concrete, minute details of everyday life. The other day, when we were chatting about optimism, I mentioned that I consider myself an optimist; what I didn't say was that you are one of the reasons for that optimism. Let us continue to raise our glasses to the arrival of the next winter, to those moments yet to unfold but already eagerly anticipated, and to those wishes that may seem a touch unconventional, yet are undeniably romantic. Let us unlock new scenes in life together; as you venture out to explore a wider world, I, too, continue to expand my own horizons through the path we share. Dare to feel deeply; allow your emotions to flow through you in their entirety, rather than letting them be stifled or diluted. In this coming year, we will meet again—in theaters, studios, bars, galleries, cinemas, or perhaps even aboard a subway train—crossing paths, weathering the winter together, and together bidding farewell to another year. It is my hope that, within the scripts of one another's lives, we remain permanent cast members, repeatedly recognizing, at various moments, that familiar sense of joy. Let us continue to dream; let our

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thoughts and conversations grow ceaselessly, much like a process of fermentation—acting as a tireless energy that gradually imbues our lives with depth and resonance. All troubles shall remain in the year just passed; and should the passage of time bring with it a flicker of unease, let us embrace it as a form of spiritual compensation bestowed by fate—a reminder to strive even more earnestly for happiness, for the final punctuation mark of every winter inevitably leads the way to spring.



生日快乐Caro, 我们又sort of一起度过了一个冬天, 从学生时代跨入了社会确实见面变成了一件不是很容易的事, 虽然很怀念我们一周见好几次的学生时代, 但是努力见面的工作日也很美好! 夏天的时候还私心希望你速速从ny回来, 很贪恋跟你一起经历的时光。那天翻看手机视频, 看到了我们提交毕业论文的那个晚上, 一切好像都在昨天, 这可能是因为我们有在努力没缺席彼此的生活带来的时间错觉。不管是从中国画院去南锣鼓巷还是从tenement museum到东村的地铁上, 又或是在西村和北锣鼓巷的bar里, 又或是忙碌一天后的美食, 在不同的寒冷中哈哈大笑和smoke, 我们像是活在瞬息全宇宙的平行世界中, 但不论哪个世界, 你都是让我无比安心的存在。新的一年希望你平安健康, 自由自在的拓宽更广阔的人生版图, 常被善良有意思的人围绕, 如果遇到新的挑战但也可以顺利的解决它们! 还有几个月就到了我们毕业论文夜的一年期, 俺等你录视频, 然后继续创造一些新的平行宇宙。

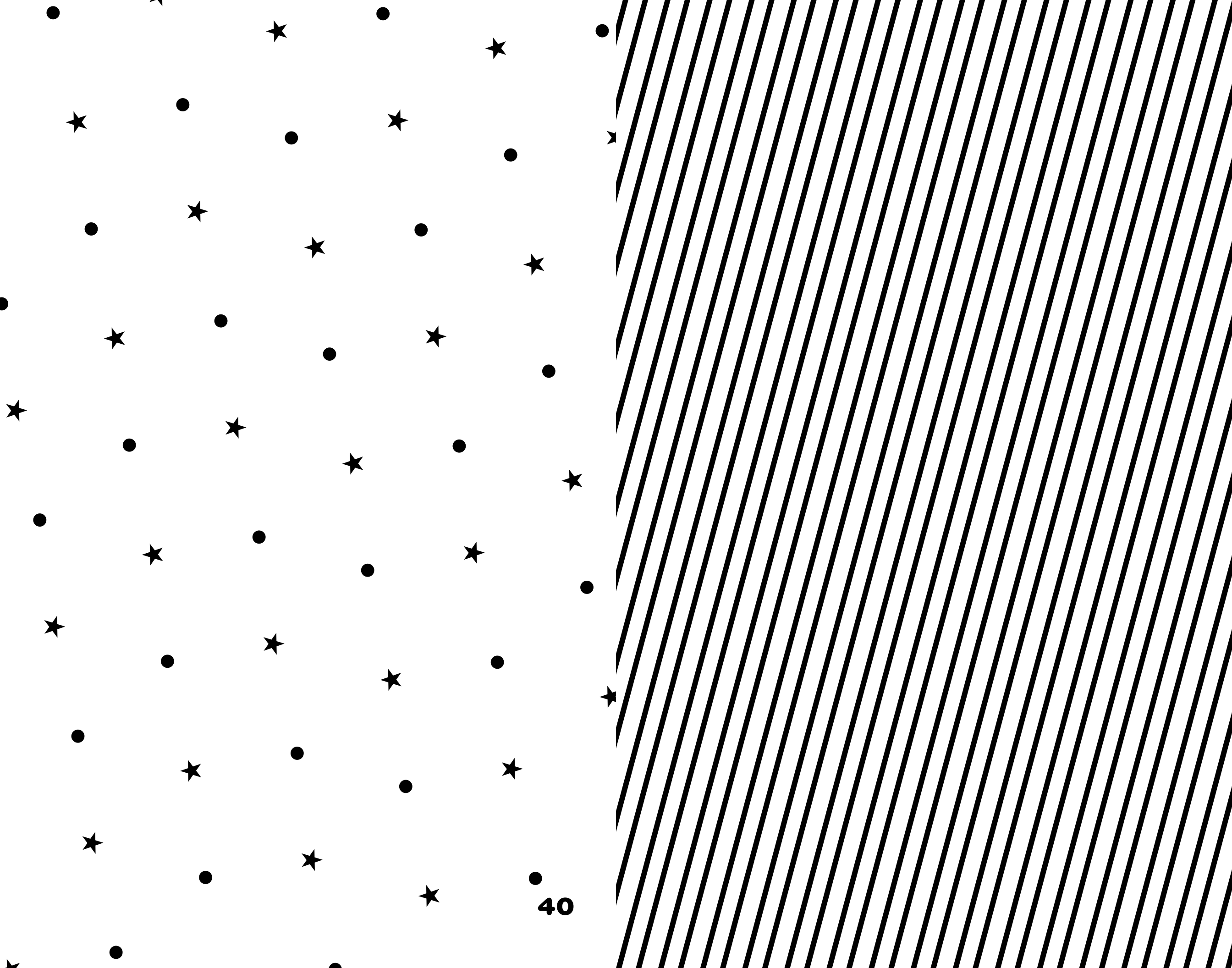
Happy Birthday, Caro! We've—sort of—spent another winter together. Since transitioning from student life into the working world, meeting up has indeed become something of a challenge. Although I deeply miss our student days when we'd see each other several times a week, the weekdays we make a conscious effort to meet up are beautiful in their own right! Back in the summer, I selfishly found myself wishing you'd hurry back from NYC, simply because I cherish the time we spend together so much. The other day, while scrolling through videos on my phone, I stumbled upon footage from the night we submitted our graduation theses; it feels as though it all happened just yesterday. Perhaps this creates a sort of temporal illusion—a sense that time hasn't truly passed—simply because we've made such an effort to remain present in each other's lives. Whether we were traveling from the China National Academy of Painting to Nanluoguxiang, riding the subway from the Tenement Museum to the East Village, hanging out in bars in the West Village or Beiluoguxiang, or simply enjoying a delicious meal after a hectic day—laughing and smoking together amidst the various shades of winter chill—it feels as though we are living in a “multiverse of madness,” inhabiting countless parallel worlds. Yet,

no matter which world we find ourselves in, you remain a presence that brings me an unparalleled sense of peace and security. As you embark on a new year of life, I wish you safety, good health, and the freedom to boldly expand the horizons of your life's journey. May you always be surrounded by kind and fascinating people; and should you encounter any new challenges, may you resolve them with ease! In just a few months, we'll be reaching the one-year anniversary of that graduation thesis night. I'll be waiting for you to record that video—and then, let's go create some brand-new parallel universes together.

虽然不知道你会什么时候看到这封信, 如果提前看到了就是提前祝你圣诞节快乐, 等你下次生日太遥远了, 所以借着圣诞给你回个贺卡吧, 报答你上次给我怒写几百字! 虽然觉得在这样的信里写感谢很奇怪, 但还是谢谢你, 虽然我知道你是自发的很想找我聊天啦, 但是谢谢陪我一起走过这几个月, 从盛夏一起迈到了大雪天, 这段我学生时代后的并不怎么容易的第一个新阶段。我一直知道我是一个分享欲很低的人, 所以每次意识到我跟你分享了很多后还是会吓了一跳, 我不知道缘由但是你是让我很心安的存在。抱歉这几天都很忙, 跟你约会也是在写ppt, 一天就只有晚上可以跟你聊两句, 希望这些都可以快快结束, 圣诞节我绝不会看一眼电脑! 圣诞快乐! 记得圣诞节陪我看真爱至上, 还有杨福东的展览也要提上日程了!

Although I don't know exactly when you'll see this, if you happen to read it early, consider this an early Merry Christmas wish! Waiting until your next birthday feels like an eternity away, so I'm taking the opportunity this Christmas to send you a card in return, to repay you for that epic, multi-hundred-word message you wrote to me last time! It feels a bit strange to express my gratitude within the pages of a letter like this, but thank you nonetheless. I know you reached out to chat simply because you genuinely wanted to—and I appreciate that—but thank you for walking alongside me these past few months, carrying me from the height of summer right into the snowy days of winter. It has been a challenging journey: the first new chapter of my life since my student days, and one that hasn't been particularly easy. I've always known that I'm someone who rarely feels the urge to share personal details; that's why, every time I realize just how much I've actually shared with you, I'm still taken aback. I can't quite pinpoint the reason why, but you are a presence in my life that brings me a profound sense of peace and security. I'm sorry that things have been so hectic lately. Even when we've managed to meet up, I've often been stuck working on PowerPoint presentations. We've been limited to just a few brief words of conversation in the evenings, but I'm hoping all this craziness wraps up soon. Come Christmas Day, I promise not to cast a single glance at my computer! Merry Christmas! Don't forget, you promised to watch *Love Actually* with me this Christmas! And we really need to put Yang Fudong's exhibition on our schedule!

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